

County Administration Workshop: September 22, 2026

1:30 p.m. - Board of Commissioners Conference Room

Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman,
Recorder

Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 1:30 p.m.

1. Declaration of Potential Conflicts of Interest

The Board declared there are no potential conflicts of interest.

2. Department Business

a. Public Works

1. Amendment for IGA with ODOT for Althouse Creek Bridge Replacement

Rob Brandes, Public Works Director, presented the amendment to the intergovernmental agreement with ODOT for the Althouse Creek Bridge replacement. The project is a full bridge reconstruction funded primarily through the state bridge program, with approximately \$2.7 million awarded and a County match of 10.27%, or approximately \$313,000. The amendment allows ODOT to perform the right-of-way and land acquisition work. The Board discussed potential easements, federal funding restrictions if property associated with marijuana production must be acquired, anticipated project cost increases, detour needs, and a projected four- to six-month closure during construction. Public Works anticipates bidding in early 2027 for construction in summer 2027. The Board also requested that Public Works continue bringing significant change orders back for discussion.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the Amendment for the IGA with ODOT for the Althouse Creek Bridge Replacement. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

b. Finance

1. Board Order 2026-054 In the Matter of Temporary Delegation of Signing Authority During the Absence of the Josephine County Finance Director

Matt Eide, Finance Director, presented Board Order 2026-054, temporarily delegating signing authority to Assistant Finance Director Trevin Mikels during the Finance Director's absence, September 28 through October 23, 2026. Mr. Eide stated the temporary authority would allow Finance business to continue during his absence and that Mr. Mikels is experienced and familiar with anticipated departmental needs.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve Board Order 2026-054, In the Matter of Temporary Delegation of Signing Authority During the Absence of the Josephine County Finance Director. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

c. Transit

1. ODOT Agreement 35810-1

Scott Chancey, Transit Manager, presented ODOT Agreement 35810-1. The amendment adds an additional quarter of funding to bridge ODOT's transition from a July-June fiscal year to the federal October-September fiscal year. The funds support rural public transportation and may be used for eligible expenses such as preventive fleet maintenance. The local match is provided through state transit funds; no County General Fund dollars are required.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve ODOT Agreement 35810-1. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

2. Spare Software Renewal Agreement

Scott Chancey, Transit Manager, presented the Spare software renewal agreement (Form SL-7542). Spare is used for demand-response dispatching and client scheduling for elderly and disabled riders, including ADA-related service tracking. The annual cost is approximately \$50,400 and is paid with federal funds, with the local match provided through state transit funds. Mr. Chancey stated the software continues to meet the department's needs and requested authorization to sign the renewal.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve the Spare software renewal agreement and authorize Scott Chancey to sign. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

d. Human Resources

1. Position Requisitions

Juvenile Justice - Group Life Counselor I/II - Refill vacated position - position vacated 9/17/2026

Recreation - Assistant Ranger - Update Job Description

Recreation - Event Coordinator - Update Job Description

Recreation - Maintenance Worker I-II - Update Job Description

Recreation - Ranger - Update Job Description

Recreation - Recreation and Cemetery Specialist - Update Job Description

Recreation - Recreation Department Director - Update Job Description

Recreation - Senior Ranger - Update Job Description and Refill Vacant Position

Recreation - Senior Administrative Supervisor - Recreation - Update Job Description

Recreation - Recreation Senior Department Specialist - Update Job Description

Recreation - Recreation Department Operations Manager - Update Job Description

Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Interim Human Resources Director, presented the position requisitions. The Juvenile Justice request is to refill a budgeted Group Life Counselor I/II position after the full-time employee moved to fill-in status. The Recreation requests update job descriptions to reflect current department structure and duties following prior organizational changes. The Senior Ranger request also includes refilling a vacancy created by retirement. Human Resources reviewed the job descriptions and recommended updated standard language. The Board had no objection to moving the requisitions and job description updates forward.

3. Board Business

a. Resolution 2026-035 Josephine County Economic Development Grant Advisory Committee - Appointments

Staff reviewed the selection process for the five proposed members of the Josephine County Economic Development Grant Advisory Committee. Candidates were interviewed individually, and selections were made to provide a broad cross-section of community perspectives and experience. The appointments are for one-year terms while the County evaluates the new advisory process. The Board also discussed the approximately \$445,000 available for grants, the October 30 application deadline, and that any unawarded funds may roll forward to the next grant cycle.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve Resolution 2026-035, appointments to the Josephine County Economic Development Grant Advisory Committee. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

b. Communications Update

Commissioner Martin provided an update on the regional emergency communications project. A recent meeting with Emergency Management, City of Grants Pass and fire service representatives addressed a broader communications system overhaul. The group is evaluating Public Safety Towers Company (PSTC), an independent tower developer, as one possible avenue for adding infrastructure. A coverage analysis identified a potential need for three additional towers beyond the County's existing four. The Board discussed ownership and lease protections, locating towers to serve County public-safety needs, project costs, and available grant opportunities, including a Homeland Security grant and larger funding opportunities anticipated in 2027. No formal action was taken.

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c. Designate a Project Coordinator for Emergency Communication

The Board discussed designating a single point of contact to keep the long-term regional communications project moving forward and coordinate the work of Emergency Management, Facilities, technical staff and grant resources. Nate Sanders was identified as having relevant prior experience and as a suitable coordinator, while technical staff would continue to be directly involved. The Board emphasized that the project should be developed for the benefit of Josephine County as a whole and not for a single department.

Commissioner Richardson moved to task Nate Sanders as Project Coordinator for the Josephine Regional Interoperational System. Commissioner Martin seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

d. Resolution 2026-036 Re-appointment to the Josephine County Fair Board - Karl Heackler

Tamra Martin, Fair Director, recommended the re-appointment of Karl Heackler to the Josephine County Fair Board. Mr. Heackler has completed his first term, serves as vice chair, and was described as an effective and professional member who works well with vendors and provides leadership at the fairgrounds. The Board also discussed the Fair Board bylaws, which limit members to three three-year terms.

Commissioner Martin moved to approve Resolution 2026-036, re-appointment of Karl Heackler to the Josephine County Fair Board. Commissioner Richardson seconded the motion. Upon roll call: Commissioner Richardson - Yes; Commissioner Martin - Yes; Commissioner Smith - Yes. Motion carried 3-0.

4. OTHER

Commissioner Richardson provided an update on the Agricultural Education Grants. Legal Counsel and Finance are working on the framework, which is expected to be patterned generally after the economic development grant process but without an advisory committee. Applications would come directly to the Board. The available funding pool is \$30,000 through the 4-H Service District and may support agricultural education opportunities such as FFA, 4-H, youth agriculture or other qualifying programs. The goal is to have the process ready in time for awards later this year.

Commissioner Richardson also discussed a proposed Department Report process. Departments would receive a standardized packet addressing department activities, key performance indicators, goals and obstacles, and would submit the completed report to the Board at least one week before appearing at an Administrative Workshop. The Board discussed having each department report approximately every six months, with about 10-15 minutes for discussion and questions. The draft template will be shared with department heads at an upcoming leadership meeting for feedback before the schedule is finalized.

5. ADDITIONAL SUBJECT MATTERS FROM COMMISSIONERS/ANNOUNCEMENTS:

Commissioner Martin had no additional announcements. The Board discussed beginning the Department Report process after department-head feedback is received; Commissioner Richardson agreed to attend the next leadership meeting.

The meeting adjourned at 2:35 p.m.